

Prayer

“Father, thank You for Joseph’s story. When I feel stuck or overlooked, remind me that You still see me. Help me stay faithful and honest, even when no one is watching. In Jesus’ name, amen.”

Personal Prayer Space

Talk to God about one area in your life that feels like a “pit” or a “prison” right now:

Activity

“Pit, Prison, Palace”

Circle which one you relate to most right now and explain why: PIT | PRISON | PALACE

Reason: _____

Notes & Group Discussion

BM2 — Lesson 2: Hannah

Barren but Not Lifeless

 **Theme: Prayer in the Pain**

 **Background Text:** 1 Samuel 1–2

 **Key Verse:** 1 Samuel 1:27 (WEB)

“I prayed for this child, and Yahweh has given me my petition which I asked of him.”

 **Appetizer – The Weight of Waiting, 1 Samuel 1:7–8 (WEB)**

“So year by year, when she went up to Yahweh’s house, her rival provoked her; therefore she wept, and didn’t eat. Elkanah her husband said to her, ‘Hannah, why do you weep? Why don’t you eat? Why is your heart grieved? Am I not better to you than ten sons?’”

Hannah carried a deep ache: she couldn’t have children and was teased for it. Waiting on God can be lonely, especially when it feels like everyone else is getting exactly what you are praying for.

 **Reflection Question:**

When have you felt like someone didn’t understand how deeply something was hurting you?

 **Main Course**

 **Bite 1 – Provoked but Persistent, 1 Samuel 1:9–11 (WEB)**

“Hannah rose up after they had eaten... She was in bitterness of soul, and prayed to Yahweh, and wept bitterly. She vowed a vow, and said, ‘Yahweh of Armies, if you will indeed look at the affliction of your servant... and will give to your servant a boy, then I will give him to Yahweh all the days of his life...’”

Hannah brought her pain straight to God. She made a vow that shifted her perspective: she wasn’t just asking for a child for herself; she was offering that child back to God. Persistence in prayer is often about moving from “give me” to “let me serve You with it.”

 Reflection Question:

What is one honest sentence you wish you could pray to God about something that hurts?

 Bite 2 – Misunderstood but Heard, 1 Samuel 1:12–16 (WEB)

“As she continued praying... Eli observed her mouth. Now Hannah spoke in her heart; only her lips moved... Eli said to her, ‘How long will you be drunk? Get rid of your wine!’

Hannah answered, ‘No, my lord, I am a woman of a sorrowful spirit... I have poured out my soul before Yahweh. Don’t consider your servant a wicked woman; for I have been speaking out of the abundance of my complaint and my provocation.’”

Even the priest misjudged her. When you are at your lowest, even “religious” people might misjudge your struggle. But Hannah didn’t let a man’s mistake stop her from talking to her Maker. God hears the prayers that are too deep for words.

 Reflection Question:

What helps you remember that God sees your heart even when others don’t?

 Bite 3 – Promise Given, Promise Kept, 1 Samuel 1:17–18, 20 (WEB)

“Then Eli answered, ‘Go in peace; and may the God of Israel grant your petition...’ So the woman went her way, and ate; and her face was no more sad... When the time had come, Hannah conceived, and bore a son; and she named him Samuel...”

Peace showed up before the answer did. Hannah left her burden at the altar. She didn’t have the baby yet, but she had the “yes” in her spirit. Sometimes God changes your heart before He changes your situation to prove He is your source of joy.

⁷I will establish my covenant between me and you and your offspring after you throughout their generations for an everlasting covenant...'

Years later, God changed Abram's name to Abraham ("Father of many"). God was calling him what he *would* be before he *saw* it. Your identity is fixed by God's promise, not your current progress.

Reflection Question:

How does it help to remember what God calls you when your situation doesn't look like it?

Dessert

Abraham's story says:

1. Real faith is honest enough to ask hard questions.
2. Real faith can still stumble, but God picks it back up.
3. God's timing is perfect, even when it feels "late."

Reflection Question:

What is there an area where you need to stop forcing outcomes and start trusting God again?

To-Go Box

- God isn't scared of your honest questions.
- Shortcuts can complicate your life even when God still loves you.
- God's promises stand, even when your patience doesn't.

Write one sentence: "God, help me trust You with _____."

Word Study

- **Abram** – “Exalted Father”
- **Abraham** – “Father of Many Nations”

El Shaddai – “God Almighty,” the all-sufficient One who sustains, provides, and fulfills His promises.

Prayer

“God Almighty, forgive me for the times I’ve tried to rush Your plan. Help me to walk before You with a trusting heart. In Jesus’ name, amen.”

Personal Prayer Space

Write about one area where you want to slow down and trust God’s timing:

Activity – “True or False”

1. Abraham never questioned God. (T / F)
2. Sarai suggested using Hagar. (T / F)
3. God changed Abram’s name. (T / F)

Notes & Group Discussion
